Billing playbook 🔒

> INTERNAL. How and when datawazi gets paid. Amounts come from `internal/pricing/PRICING.md`; this file covers the rules. Never paste payment rules into public material.

When money moves

Engagement	Schedule	Invoice when
Readiness audit (1–2 weeks)	**100% upfront**, or 50% to book + 50% at readout	Before the audit starts
Training workshop	**100% upfront**	When the date is confirmed
Build, smaller (≈ under RM20k or ≤ 6 weeks)	**50 / 50**	50% on SOW signature · 50% on go-live (UAT signed)
Build, larger	**40 / 40 / 20**	40% on signature · 40% on design sign-off or build complete · 20% on go-live
Change request	100% on CR signature (small) or added to the next milestone	When the CR is signed
Support retainer	**Monthly in advance**, minimum 3 months	1st of each month
Third-party costs (cloud, licences, AI usage)	Client pays the vendor directly in their own account. Otherwise passed through at cost, monthly in arrears, with the vendor invoice attached	Monthly

Rules

1. **No work before the first payment clears.** Kickoff is booked for after the deposit lands, not on signature.

2. **Payment terms: 14 days** from invoice date (the invoice template default). GLC and government: accept their terms (typically 30–60 days) but **require a purchase order (PO) before any work**.
3. **GLCs and government often refuse deposits.** Replace the deposit with smaller, more frequent milestones (e.g. 30 / 30 / 30 / 10) and put the PO number on every invoice.
4. **Hypercare is included** in the project price. It is never invoiced separately.
5. **Late payment:** reminder on day 1 overdue (email 12), second reminder on day 7 (email 13), a call to the sponsor on day 14. The MSA allows pausing work after written notice for undisputed overdue invoices.
6. **Every invoice** gets a row in `Payment_Tracker.xlsx` the moment it's sent. Review overdue invoices every Monday.
7. **Numbering:** quotations `DW-Q-YYYY-NNN`, invoices `DW-INV-YYYY-NNN`. One sequence per year, never reused, never deleted (cancel with a note instead).
8. **Tax:** no SST on invoices until datawazi is SST-registered. E-invoicing applies only above LHDN's turnover threshold. Confirm both with the accountant at registration and annually.

The document trail for one project

```
Proposal & SOW SOW-… (price + schedule + terms, signed; + MSA the first time, + NDA/DPA if needed)
   → Invoice 1 (deposit, same day) → paid → kickoff
   → Invoice 2 (milestone) → paid
   → Invoice 3 (final, on go-live) → paid → hypercare → retainer invoices (monthly)
```

The SOW number goes on every invoice. The PO number (if any) goes on every invoice. A separate quotation (`DW-Q-…`) is issued **only when the client's procurement asks for one** (common with GLCs before a PO); it must match the Proposal & SOW.

Files

File	What
`sales/proposals/proposal-and-sow-template.md`	**The** client document: proposal + SOW + price + signature
`sales/billing/Quotation_Template.xlsx`	Formal quotation, only if the client's procurement asks for one
`sales/billing/Invoice_Template.xlsx`	Client invoice: totals, SST and due date calculate
`internal/finance/Payment_Tracker.xlsx`	Every invoice: due, paid, overdue, per-client totals

File	What
internal/finance/ Client_Workflow.pdf	One-page workflow with payment points
sales/emails/email-templates.md	Emails 11–13: sending an invoice, reminders

Bank details on the invoice are placeholders until the business account is open.